In Praise of the Venerable Lokeśvara Siṃhanāda

Siṃhanādalokeśvarabhaṭṭārakastuti · Toh 1173 · Derge Tengyur

རྗེབཙུན་འཇིག་རྟེན་དབང་ཕྱུག་སེང་གེ་ནད་གཙོ་བསྟོད་པ

In Praise of the Venerable Lokeśvara Siṃhanāda, known in Sanskrit as the Siṃhanādalokeśvarabhaṭṭārakastuti and in Tibetan as Jetsün Jikten Wangchuk Sengé Dra la Töpa, is a hymn in ornate verse to Siṃhanāda, the "Lion's Roar," a form of Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva of compassion, who is especially invoked as a healer of disease. Its verses praise his love for beings, his lion mount, his trident and sword, his crystal rosary and his blazing matted locks, and they ask him to protect the listener, to crush the sicknesses and afflictions of beings, and to fulfill their aims, before closing with a dedication of merit so that all beings may enter the assembly of the Victors and themselves become guides. The colophon names the author as a glorious lord of poets called the Twice-born Guardian, and records that the hymn was translated by the monk Dharmapālabhadra, the translator of Zhalu, at the command of the holy guru Gyalwa Chennga Rinpoché. It is Toh 1173 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of praises (stotra).

In the language of India: sihanādalokeśrarabhanṭārakasyastuti
In the language of Tibet: In Praise of the Venerable Lokeśvara Siṃhanāda.

Homage to noble Lokeśvara (Avalokiteśvara).

Wishing here to number what is as countless as the abodes of existence,
Brilliant master poets have told, in words of the greatest delight,
The host of your qualities. Just so, I too, though dull of mind,
Set down fresh words of praise in two ways.

He who teaches awakening, the far shore of vast existence,
Who, making a long age as a single moment, took on a body out of love,
And establishes all sentient beings without exception, wherever they dwell, in omniscience itself:
May that loving protector of beings, Siṃhanāda, be victorious!

When the hare-marked moon displays its light and its course in the sky,
He who, skilled in the Dharma, accomplishes each and every thing like Viśvakarman (the divine craftsman),
Fashions the essence of all that is white into a delightful form:
He too is Siṃhanāda. Radiating rays of light, may he be victorious!

What need has he to take pains to keep a blazing jewel upon his head?
He holds close this lamp, whose nature is good deeds.
Thus he crushes the māra of doubt, which is like a snake:
May that Siṃhanāda, victorious over all opponents, protect you!

Skilled in the ground of the three worlds, he crushes the side of Māra;
He remains, crushing the sickness that dwells in the serpent lords;
His trident crushes the root of going to hell:
Homage to Siṃhanāda, the excellent son of Reṇu!

A crystal rosary too, like the very finest white,
He holds in his hand that works virtue, and so utterly subdues Yama, the lord of death.
Supremely beautiful, a play of jewels, endowed with love and moral discipline,
May that Siṃhanāda of joyful eyes protect you!

These lovely rays of his matted locks that fall to his heart,
Blazing and quivering, lie upon Śeṣa, the serpent who bears the earth,
Like a sapphire at play in the luminous citadel of the ocean of milk:
May that Siṃhanāda show you every auspicious thing!

Whatever conditions have become the means of beings' utter ruin,
May that Siṃhanāda, who pacifies the ten māras with the edge of his sword,
At whose feet the three realms of existence bow,
Crush and dispel them, the sicknesses and afflictions of beings!

Even the lord of beasts, glorious, a worthy refuge for the race of gods,
Is free of all the pride of being plainly known as the vehicle of the Sugata (the Buddha).
He who holds within his body the vast activity of the Sugatas,
May that Siṃhanāda accomplish the aims you desire!

By the stores of virtue's fruit, peaceful by nature, gathered
From my thus recounting in full the host of your qualities,
May all these beings without exception not fall into the hands of the Lord of Joy (Māra),
And may they fully enter the assembly of the ocean of Victors.

Having fully attained a body whose nature is this Protector's form,
May all these beings without exception, however many there are, become guides themselves.

This mirror for people's faces, polished utterly clean,
Was made by the glorious lord of poets, the Twice-born Guardian.

This completes the Praise of the Venerable Lokeśvara Siṃhanāda. At the command of the glorious holy guru Gyalwa Chennga Rinpoché, it was translated by the translator of Zhalu, the monk Dharmapālabhadra.

Translator's Notes

• The poem is ornate and seems to play on double meanings. In the first verse, "in two ways" ('gro ba gnyis su) is obscure; it may mean words of praise that carry a double sense. The epithet "excellent son of Reṇu" in the fifth verse is unexplained and is given as the Tibetan has it. In the seventh verse the phrase rendered "luminous citadel" ('od gsal mkhar) is uncertain. The "Lord of Joy" in the dedication is taken as the god of desire, whom Buddhist poets identify with Māra. The author's name, gnyis skyes srung ba, could not be identified with confidence and is translated by its meaning, "the Twice-born Guardian"; its Sanskrit form is not known.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.